Preparation Guide for Apprentices

This document summarizes the intention, core areas and the format of the behaviour-anchored interviews. Use it as a reference for your preparation.

Intention: Interviewers from the Service Centre will engage apprentices in technical interviews designed to evaluate core engineering and design thinking skills across any functional specialization (Frontend, Backend, QA, Data Engineering, DevOps.). This interview prioritizes process, reasoning, and professional habits.

Format:

- Online session with interviewer(s), Videos on.
- Session should be recorded for audit purposes.
- The training team will share performance feedback with apprentices after the interview.

Failure to record and turn on your video during the interview will result in a score of 0.

Coverage: The interviews will evaluate your skills in three core evaluation modules:

- ***Problem Decomposition & Planning*** - focuses on how the candidate translates an ambiguous requirement into a structured plan
- ***Debugging, Testing & Self-Correction*** - focuses on the candidate's ability to identify errors and refine their work under changing conditions.
- ***Trade-off Analysis & Contextual Clarity*** - focuses on the candidate's professional maturity and decision-making logic.

Evaluation:

- The interview will progress linearly from problem decomposition to trade-off analysis.
- At each stage, the interviewer will provide a problem context, pose a question and give a rating (using the 0-5 rating scale) based on the quality of response you give.
- In the scoring, interviewers will move away from **"evaluating the solution"** and instead focus on **"observing the journey"** you take to reach it.

Interview Period

- All interviews will start on 21 st Sept 2026 and end on 25th Sept 2026. You should expect an invitation to attend your interview any time from today.
- If you have not received your interview invitation by 18th Sept 2026, kindly speak to Kevin Rukundo to address this.
- Interview date and time will vary for apprentice based on the availability of the interviewer(s).

Additional Notes

The interview is not designed to harass, trick or fail anyone. Rather, it is an opportunity to help you discover your strengths and gaps in the skills we prioritize on client project teams.

1. Stay calm and confident throughout the interview and seek clarity where necessary.
2. Seek guidance from your mentors if you need help preparing.
3. You may team up with your colleagues in mock interviews to help you prepare.

Module 1: Problem Decomposition & Planning

Goal: Show how you turn an unclear or complex requirement into a clear, structured plan before starting implementation.

What to demonstrate:

- **Clarify the Scope**
  Identify constraints, assumptions, and any unclear parts of the requirement before moving forward.
- **Break the Problem into Parts**
  Divide the overall task into smaller, well-defined components that can be solved independently.
- **Plan the Order of Work**
  Explain the logical sequence you would follow to implement the solution before writing or changing anything.

Module 2: Debugging, Testing & Self-Correction

Goal: Show how you identify problems, test your assumptions, and improve your solution when new information appears.

What to demonstrate:

- **Form a Clear Hypothesis**
  State what you believe is causing the issue and explain how you would test that assumption before attempting a fix.
- **Isolate the Cause Systematically**
  Narrow down components or variables step by step to identify the root cause of the problem.
- **Adapt When New Information Appears**
  Reassess your understanding of the problem and adjust your approach when new clues or constraints emerge.

Module 3: Trade-off Analysis & Contextual Clarity

Goal: Show how you evaluate different solution options and explain your decisions in a clear, practical way.

What to demonstrate:

- **Compare Alternative Approaches**
  Consider two or more possible solutions and explain why you would choose one over the others.
- **Align With Context and Goals**
  Connect your solution to the user needs, project constraints, or business objectives involved.

- **Communicate Clearly**
  Explain your reasoning and technical ideas in a clear and concise way without relying on unnecessary jargon.